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ChatGPT and the Future of Public Policy Analysis: Potential and Pitfalls of using ChatGPT in Policymaking

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Abstract

Scholars increasingly rely on new artificial intelligence models for convenience and simple access to necessities due to the rapid evolution of scientific literature and technology. The invention of ChatGPT by OpenAI stands out as a key example of how significant advances in large language model (LLM) technology have recently changed the field of artificial intelligence (AI). Since ChatGPT's development, it has been tested by multiple sectors on various topics to see how well it functions in a natural and conversational mode. The crucial question is how much ChatGPT can influence public policy analysis. In this article, the researcher briefly explains ChatGPT's potential and the difficulties that users, such as researchers or policymakers, may continue to face.

Keywords: ChatGPT; artificial intelligence; public policy; policymaking

Introduction

ChatGPT is an exceptionally advanced conversational artificial intelligence interface that has revolutionized how people interact with technology [6]. It uses Natural Language

Processing (NLP) techniques to create a highly realistic and engaging user experience, allowing them to interact with ChatGPT as they would a human. What sets ChatGPT apart from other chatbots or virtual assistants is its ability to answer questions and provide a brief answer by acknowledging and challenging wrong assumptions or assumptions made by the user [3]. When asked a query, ChatGPT will automatically generate an explanation based on thousands of online resources, frequently without the user's further interaction [4]. As a result, it has been claimed that people have used ChatGPT to create academic papers and essays, and the system can provide supporting references upon request. Still, researchers claimed that the references are not corrected [1,5].

The evolution of artificial intelligence technology has made it a robust platform with enormous potential to improve public policy analysis. Artificial intelligence systems are regarded as essential tools in policymaking due to their advanced skills in analyzing large datasets and identifying patterns. Policymakers can decide more accurately and precisely by using data-based insights rather than intuition or assumptions to inform their decisions [7]. ChatGPT stands out among the new AI-related technologies as promising and can alter how we conduct public policy analysis thoroughly. Natural language processing's unique ability for communication enhances channels of exchange between humans and machines [2]. It offers crucial input into intricate decision-making procedures at all tiers of international government agencies. But it is difficult to claim that employing ChatGPT will have a significant positive or negative impact on our society's governance, both in terms of efficiency improvements and the development of transparency.

Positive Impact of Using ChatGPT in Public Policy

ChatGPT is a highly sophisticated and advanced natural language processing tool capable of supporting public policy analysis and formulation. Its versatility makes it a beneficial resource for policymakers who want to navigate the complexities of modern governance more easily. While considering the benefits of incorporating ChatGPT in this particular context, there are numerous benefits to be acknowledged:

1. With its advanced language processing capabilities, ChatGPT can delve deep into complex linguistic structures and often discover too subtle patterns for humans to understand. This makes it an essential tool for dissecting complex public debates surrounding policy issues, as it can accurately identify recurring themes and subtle arguments that might otherwise go unnoticed by people. ChatGPT allows policymakers to make informed decisions based on a thorough understanding of all sides of the issue by providing a comprehensive analysis of different perspectives on a given issue.
2. ChatGPT is an exceptional tool capable of analyzing large amounts of unstructured data with great accuracy and precision. Its extraordinary analytical capabilities allow it to extract essential insights from large amounts of data, which can provide valuable inputs for policymaking in various domains. Moreover, using ChatGPT's advanced analytical functionality, policymakers can save considerable time and resources compared to manual data analysis methods.
3. ChatGPT, an advanced platform with predictive modeling capabilities, empowers its users to create and predict the impact of policy changes in a comprehensive and insightful manner. Using its sophisticated algorithms and data analytics tools,

ChatGPT enables policymakers and analysts to evaluate complex policy proposals by predicting their potential consequences on various societal aspects. Such depth of analysis can lead to informed decision-making that considers all possible outcomes while minimizing unintended negative impacts or risks associated with new policies.

4. Policymakers can be facilitated to access insights and perform analysis. This implies that they can acquire important information at any moment without being constrained by the availability constraints posed by human analysts. ChatGPT's accessibility helps policymakers be more agile in their decision-making processes, as they can immediately access data-driven insights whenever needed.
5. By offering a comprehensive and multidimensional approach, data analysis can effectively reduce bias in policymaking. With its ability to uncover blind spots or unconscious biases inherent in the decision-making process, this approach is essential in promoting equity and fairness in policy implementation.

Potential Cons of Using ChatGPT

Although ChatGPT has tremendous potential to help in various domains, it is essential to note some shortcomings that may hinder its use in public policy analysis and policymaking.

1. The use of ChatGPT in policymaking has raised concerns about the level of transparency in the decision-making process. This is mainly due to the complexity of the algorithm employed by ChatGPT, which humans need help understanding. Identifying and understanding all the factors that affect the outputs generated through this platform can be

particularly challenging, resulting in a lack of transparency or visibility into the results produced by ChatGPT. The absence of transparency that arises here poses significant challenges for policymakers who may struggle to trust these findings and make decisions based on them with confidence.

2. The use of ChatGPT in public policy analysis raises significant ethical concerns. The potential consequences of perpetuating bias and promoting injustice cannot be overstated. This can lead to discriminatory practices and policies that undermine social justice efforts. Furthermore, the complexity of analyzing large datasets makes it difficult to detect hidden or inherent biases in the training data used by ChatGPT. Thus, if such biases are not detected during analysis, they may influence decision-making processes without being noticed.
3. ChatGPT, although equipped to respond to a wide range of inputs, is bound by limitations set by its training data. This means that ChatGPT's ability to generate responses may be hampered if the input data it receives is limited or biased. As a result, there is a possibility that the outputs generated by ChatGPT may not accurately reflect the sentiments and views of the larger population on the issues at hand. As a result, it may formulate policy decisions without considering the needs and perspectives of all stakeholders, which may have potentially harmful consequences.
4. ChatGPT's functionality depends primarily on the text input it receives. However, due to its limited ability to understand the overall context surrounding a policy issue, there may be instances where the responses it generates may not be adequately suited to address specific issues or policy-related situations. This lack of understanding can

further lead to inadequate data collection and analysis, leading to uninformed policy decisions with potentially serious repercussions.

Conclusion

In conclusion, ChatGPT technology has the potential to revolutionize public policy analysis by improving communication between humans and machines. It can provide valuable input into complex decision-making processes at all levels of government agencies worldwide, thereby increasing efficiency and transparency in administration. Despite its advantages, policymakers and researchers must consider several challenges when using this emerging technology.

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